

Working with ZoneAlarm Pro

Here are a few tips to make working with ZoneAlarm easier and more efficient

Setting up custom security levels

ZoneAlarm comes with three zones—Internet, Trusted and Blocked, and three security levels—off, medium, high—that are enough for a novice. It is advisable to make changes to the default settings to increase, or decrease the security provided in each of these zones and security levels.

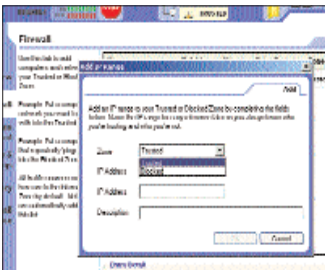
Select the firewall tab in the main ZoneAlarm window. Click on the Custom button in the concerned zone. Now select, or unselect all the required fields to customise your security settings. After you are done, click on Ok.



You can customise your firewall settings in ZoneAlarm Pro

Adding groups of computers to your security zones

In order to add a group of computers to your trusted or blocked zone, click on Firewall in the left navigation bar, and then select the Zones tab at the top of the ZoneAlarm window. Click on **Add > IP Range**. A window pops up wherein you can enter the selected computers in the trusted or blocked zone.



You can add a range of IP addresses to various security zones

Enter a range of IP addresses in the appropriate box, enter a description and then press OK. You will not be alerted everytime someone attempts to access your computer.

Getting the best out of Program Control

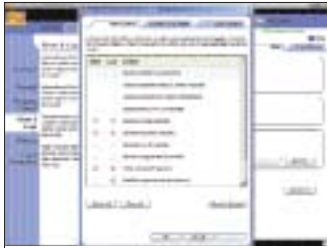
Program control allows you to specify whether programs should be allowed to access the Internet. The setting should be initially kept at Medium when the program learns which programs should be allowed Internet access. It can later be turned to High

When you start a program such as MSN messenger for the first time, an Alert window shows up asking you whether it should allow the program to access the Net. Check the 'Remember this answer

the next time I use this program' box, and then click on Yes.

But this is not advisable since it gives uncontrolled access rights to the program. A better option is to allow the program to access the network but not letting ZoneAlarm remember the answer. The advantage of using this method is that you will be alerted and asked to grant permission if multiple instances of the same program are trying to access the Internet. This prevents hackers from using newer instances of programs with access permissions to gain entry into your system.

By clicking on the Advanced Tab, you can also specify what action to perform for programs in the various zones.



ZoneAlarm is highly customisable

Automatic Lock

Turn the Automatic Lock on if your computer is left unattended for long periods. By hitting the Custom button, you can specify when the lock activates and what programs it allows to access the Net.



Use Automatic Lock for added safety

Alerts and Logs

In the Alerts and Logs section, you can specify which Alerts to show, and which programs to log.



You can choose which alerts and logs you want to see

Sometimes, you get too many alerts, which may distract you from your work. At the same time, you would want to be alerted when there is an attack on your PC. You should manually specify which events are to be logged and when you are to be alerted. You can do this by clicking on the Advanced tab and choosing the relevant fields.



CATEGORY	Firewalls Test						
Developer	Symantec	Zonelabs	Kerio Technologies	Network Associates	Microsoft	ISS	Sygate
Product Name	Norton Personal Firewall 2003	ZoneAlarm Pro v3.7.159	Kerio Personal firewall Pro 2.1.5	McAfee Personal Firewall Plus	Windows XP ICF	BlackICE PC Protection 3.6	Sygate Personal Firewall Pro v5.0
Ease of Use	10.5	12	9	9	9	8.25	9.75
Features	22.5	23.75	13.75	18.75	10	15	15
Port scan testing	20	20	13.33	20	13.33	13.33	20
Hostile scripts/ embedded objects test	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
Depth of Configuration	8	8	6	6	4	4	6
Updating	1.67	1.67	1.67	1.67	0.00	1.67	1.67
Resource Utilisation	3	5	3	1	4	3	3
Overall Score	65.67	70.42	46.75	56.42	40.33	45.25	55.42